

HOUSE No. 2186

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Marcus S. Vaughn

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to the prevention of unemployment fraud.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Marcus S. Vaughn</i>	<i>9th Norfolk</i>	<i>1/3/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 2186

By Representative Vaughn of Wrentham, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 2186) of Marcus S. Vaughn for legislation to establish a special commission (including members of the General Court) to study and report on the policies and procedures of the Department of Unemployment Assistance to prevent and address unemployment fraud. Labor and Workforce Development.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 1960 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to the prevention of unemployment fraud.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Notwithstanding any general or special laws to the contrary, there shall be established a
2 commission to study and report on the policies and procedures of the department of
3 unemployment assistance to prevent and address unemployment fraud. The commission shall:
4 (1) identify and review current policies to prevent and address fraudulent unemployment claims;
5 (2) compile and review data concerning the frequency and extent of unemployment fraud that
6 has occurred during the 2019 novel coronavirus pandemic, also known as COVID-19; (3)
7 evaluate the effectiveness of current policies to prevent unemployment fraud; and (4)
8 recommend evidence-based strategies or policies that can be established to prevent future
9 fraudulent unemployment claims.

10 The commission shall be composed of 8 members as follows: the secretary of labor and
11 workforce development or a designee, who shall serve as chair; the speaker of the house of
12 representatives or a designee; the president of the senate or a designee; the house minority leader
13 or a designee; the senate minority leader or a designee; the director of the department of
14 unemployment assistance or a designee; the state auditor or a designee; and the attorney general
15 or a designee.

16 The commission shall submit a final report with its findings and any recommendations to
17 the clerks of the house of representative and the senate and the joint committee on labor and
18 workforce development not later than December 31, 2027.